Live Track

USER MANUAL · SCHOOL TRANSPORT

Every Bus, Every Child, Step by Step.

How a school, its bus attendants and its parents use Live Track every day: following each bus live, checking every child on and off, and being told at once when something is not right.

School office

Sets up buses, routes and students. Watches every bus and every alert from the dashboard.

Bus attendant

Ticks each child on and off the bus on a phone. Tells parents about delays in one tap.

Parent

Sees the bus live, minutes to the stop, and gets a message when the child boards and gets off.

Version 1 · manual check-in · November 2026 · Kigali, Rwanda

IN ONE PAGE

What Live Track does

A GPS tracker in each bus reports where the bus is every few seconds. On every trip, the bus attendant marks each child **on** and **off**. Live Track puts the two together: the school and the parents always know where the bus is **and who is on it**.

Where is the bus?

- Live position, speed and engine on/off from the tracker.
- Knows when the bus is at each stop on its route.
- Works out the distance and minutes to each parent's stop.

Who is on it?

- The attendant taps each child **On** and **Off**.
- The parent gets a message within seconds.
- The school sees on board / still to pick up / dropped off.

Who signs in where

WHO	OPENS	SIGNS IN WITH
School office (admin)	`/auth` → School sign in	Email + password
Bus attendant	`/auth` → School sign in	Phone number + password
Parent	`/parent` → I'm a parent	Phone number + password
Driver	Nothing to do	The GPS tracker in the bus reports by itself

The key rule: attendance is counted per trip, not per day. Morning (home → school) and afternoon (school → home) are two separate trips. A child driven to school by car in the morning and bussed home in the afternoon is never marked absent.

Accounts are created by the school, there is no public sign-up. Parents and attendants receive a **6-digit activation code** and choose their own password the first time. The same code is used to reset a forgotten password. A code is valid for 30 days and locks after 5 wrong tries.

THE PEOPLE

Four sides, one journey

Each person sees only what they need. A parent only ever sees their own children and their bus.

School office (admin)

- Registers buses, routes, stops, drivers, attendants, students and parents.
- Sees every bus live with **on board / expected / absent** counts.
- Handles safety alerts: wrong bus, no-show, child left on the bus.
- Sends messages to the parents of one bus or of all buses.
- Downloads attendance reports in Excel and PDF.

Parent

- Follows the bus live and sees **km and minutes** to their stop.
- Is told when the child **boards**, **arrives at school** and **gets off**.
- Says "not riding today" for one trip or a whole day.
- Receives delay and incident messages from the bus.
- One account for all their children.

Bus attendant

- Sees the trip list: which children to pick up at each stop.
- Taps each child **On** and **Off**.
- Sends one-tap announcements: traffic, late, accident, breakdown.
- Does the final **"bus is empty"** check to close the trip.

Driver and student

- **Driver:** just drives. The tracker wired into the bus reports the position by itself.
- **Student:** needs no phone. The attendant marks them.
- Later, a fingerprint reader at the door will do the attendant's tap (*under construction*).

Safety rule: the driver drives, the attendant marks. If the check-in screen is opened by the driver, it locks while the bus is moving.

FOR THE SCHOOL OFFICE · ONCE

Setting up your school

Sign in at `/auth` and work down the left menu: first **Fleet**, then **Students & parents**. Press `Ctrl K` at any time to search for a page, student, parent or bus.

1 Add the buses FLEET → VEHICLES

Name, plate and number of seats. Enter the tracker's 15-digit **IMEI** (on its label), then send the tracker the setup SMS shown on the page. The bus switches from *Waiting for the tracker* to *Connected*.

2 Draw the routes and stops FLEET → ROUTES & STOPS

One route per bus. Add the stops **in morning order** on the map (first pick-up → … → school) and finish with the **school** stop. Each stop has a circle: when the bus enters it, Live Track knows it is at that stop.

3 Add drivers and attendants FLEET → DRIVERS / BUS ATTENDANTS

Assign each to a bus. For an attendant, enter their phone number: a **6-digit activation code** appears. Give it to them.

4 Register the students STUDENTS & PARENTS → STUDENTS

Add student, or **Import CSV** for a whole list. For each child:

- name, class, student number, and a photo only with the parent's consent;
- **bus**, **morning pick-up stop** and **afternoon drop-off stop** (they can differ);
- **one or two parents** with their phone numbers: brothers and sisters share the same parent;
- a note for the attendant, e.g. "allergic to peanuts", "gets off with her sister".

5 Invite the parents STUDENTS & PARENTS → PARENTS

Each new parent gets an activation code. Copy the ready-made **WhatsApp / SMS message** and send it. The page shows who has activated the app; **Reset password** gives a parent a new code.

> **Ready.** From the next morning, attendants open their trip list and parents start receiving messages.

FOR PARENTS AND ATTENDANTS

Getting into the app

No sign-up and no email needed. Your school gives you a code, you choose your password once.

1 · Receive a code

The school sends you a message: *"Your Live Track code is **482 913**..."*

2 · First time here?

Parents open `/parent`, attendants `/auth`. Tap **First time here?** (attendants: **Activate your account**).

3 · Choose a password

Enter your phone number, the 6-digit code and a new password. You are signed in.

Next times

Phone number + password. The phone number can be typed any way: `0788 200 001`, `+250788200001` or `788200001`.

Forgot the password?

Ask the school office. They press **Reset password** on your name and give you a new code; you then follow the same 3 steps.

Install it like an app

PHONE	HOW
Android	Open the site in Chrome, tap **Install app** at the bottom (or menu ⋮ → *Install app*).
iPhone	Open the site in Safari, tap **Share** → **Add to Home Screen**.

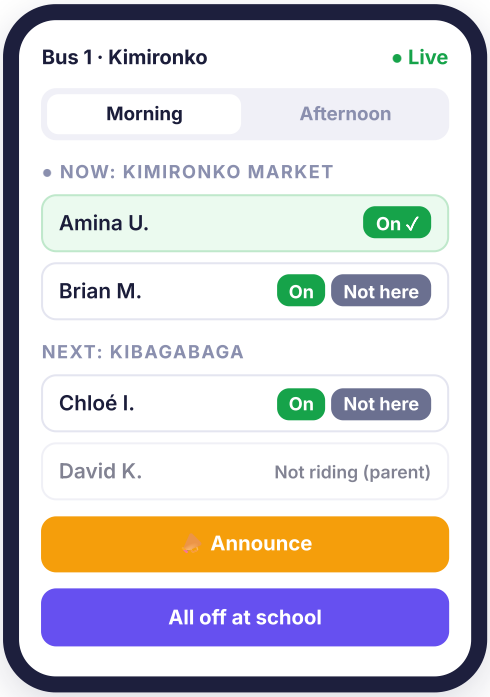
Then allow **notifications** when asked (or later in ⚙ Settings), so messages arrive even when the app is closed.

> **Codes are personal.** A code works for 30 days, only for the phone number it was made for, and locks after 5 wrong tries. Never share it.

FOR THE BUS ATTENDANT

Checking children on and off

One screen, big buttons. It works without network: taps are saved on the phone and sent later with their real time.



1 Start the trip

Sign in, tap **Start morning trip** (or the **Afternoon** tab). Children are grouped **by stop, in route order**. Parents are told the bus has started.

2 At each stop

The stop the bus is at jumps to the top by itself. Tap **On** when a child gets on, **Not here** if they don't come. Children whose parent said *not riding* are already greyed out.

3 Something happens on the road

Announce → Heavy traffic +10 / +20 / +30 min · Running late · Accident (all safe) · Breakdown · your own text. Every parent on the bus is told; accident and breakdown also alert the school.

4 At school (morning)

All off at school marks every child on board as dropped off. Afternoon: tap **Off here** for each child at their stop.

5 End the trip

Tap **End trip**, walk to the back of the bus and confirm **"the bus is empty"**. A trip cannot close while a child is still marked on board.

Made a mistake? The ↶ button undoes the last tap; the parent receives a short correction. A child who is not on your list (wrong bus) can still be added: search the name, the school is told.

HOW IT FLOWS

A school day, step by step

One child, Amina, on Bus 1. This is what each side does and sees.

Morning · home → school

06:15 · Parent (optional)
If Amina is going by car or is sick, the parent taps **Not riding**.

06:40 · Bus starts its trip
The attendant taps **Start morning trip**.

> 🚌 Bus 1 has started the morning pickup

06:52 · One stop away
The bus reaches the stop before Amina's.

> 🚌 Bus 1 is one stop away · about 4 min

06:58 · Amina boards
The attendant taps **On**.

> ✅ Amina boarded Bus 1 at Kimironko · 06:58

07:20 · Delay on the road
Announce → Heavy traffic +15.

> ⚠️ Bus 1: heavy traffic, about 15 min late

07:45 · Arrival at school
All off at school, then **End trip**.

> 🏫 Amina arrived at school · 07:45

08:30 · School check
Class register vs. bus list: everyone accounted for.

Afternoon · school → home

15:30 · Boarding at school
The attendant opens the **Afternoon** tab and taps each child **On**.

> ✅ Amina is on Bus 1, heading home

15:40 · Bus leaves
A child on the list who was not checked on → the school is alerted.

16:05 · Getting close
The parent sees the bus on the map, the km and the minutes left.

> Bus 1 is 2.3 km away · about 7 min

16:12 · Drop-off
The attendant taps **Off here** at Amina's stop.

> 🏠 Amina got off at Kimironko · 16:12

16:40 · End of trip
Back at the depot: **End trip** and the "bus is empty" walk-through.

16:50 · If something is wrong
A child still marked on board after the engine stops →

> 🚨 1 child not dropped off on Bus 1. Check the bus now.

REAL LIFE

What happens when…

The rules Live Track applies by itself, so no child is forgotten and nobody is alarmed for nothing.

SITUATION	WHAT LIVE TRACK DOES	WHO IS TOLD
Parent says "not riding"	The child is marked *Not riding* for that trip; the bus does not wait. Can be set for today, tomorrow or a date, and cancelled.	Attendant (list)
Child not at the stop	**Not here** is tapped, or the bus leaves the stop without the child → *No-show*.	Parent, school
Came by car, goes home by bus	Counted per trip: never marked absent for the day.	Nobody
Child gets on the wrong bus	Accepted (safety first) and flagged.	School, parent
Dropped far from home	An *Off* tap far from the child's stop raises an alert.	School
Child left on the bus	Still marked on board 10 min after the engine stops → urgent alert.	School (urgent)
Bus breaks down	**Trips & check-in → Move to another bus** moves the whole list; parents follow the new bus.	Parents
No mobile network	Taps are saved on the phone and sent later with their real time and place.	Parents, once sent
Wrong tap	↶ undoes it; the parent gets a short correction.	Parent
Driver opens the check-in screen	It locks while the bus is moving.	—
Tracker unplugged or silent	The bus shows *Connection lost* with its last known position and the reason.	School

Class register. Teachers tick present/absent in **Class register**. Live Track compares it with the bus: *All good*, *Came by car*, *Came another way*, *Absent (excused)*, or **Check now** / **Urgent** when a child boarded the bus but is not in class.

FOR THE SCHOOL OFFICE · EVERY DAY

The school dashboard

The left menu is in order of daily use. Click the button next to the logo to fold it into icons and give the map the full screen.

PAGE	USE IT TO
Overview	Today's morning and afternoon at a glance: on board, still to pick up, dropped, not riding, no-shows. Every bus with its live status, the latest check-ins and parent notices.
Live map	Every bus on the map with its status, speed and last report. Fold the menu for a bigger map.
Trips & check-in	Each bus's list for any date, stop by stop, with times. Open a trip or move it to another bus.
Safety alerts	No-shows, wrong bus, left at school, far drop-off, child left on bus, incidents. Tap the parent's number to call, then **Handled**.
Students & parents	Add, edit, import students; parents' activation status, invitations and password resets.
Fleet	Vehicles and trackers, routes and stops, drivers, bus attendants.
Announcements	Send a message to all parents, or to the parents of one bus.
Class register	Tick present/absent per class and compare with the bus lists.
Attendance reports	Week, month or custom period: rides per day and per child, no-shows, ridership %. Download **Excel** or **PDF**.
Trip history	Where each bus went, km driven, stops and any signal losses, per day or period, with a PDF report.
Fingerprint check-in	*Under construction*: consent counts and the list of readers to install.

🔎 Search

`Ctrl K` or `/` opens search: type a child, parent, bus or page name.

🔔 Bell

Top right: open safety alerts. A red number means something needs action.

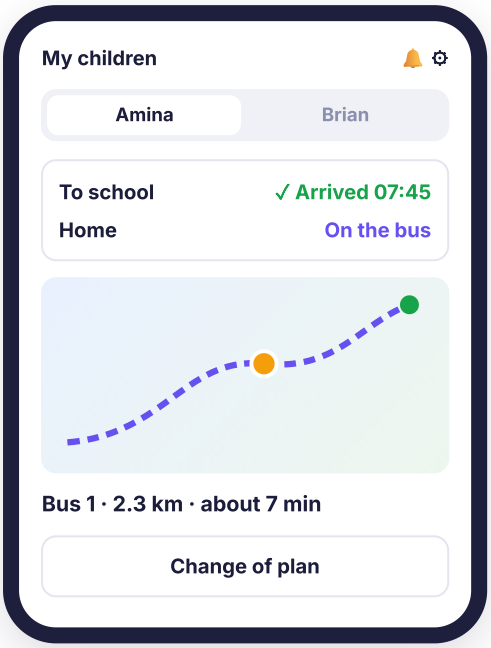
👤 Your menu

Top right: your notifications, light/dark mode and **Sign out**.

FOR PARENTS

The parent app

Open `/parent` and sign in with your phone number. Everything is on one screen.



- **All your children on one screen.** Tap a name to switch.
- **Today's status** for *To school* and *Home*, with the times.
- **The bus live on the map** with the minutes and km to your stop. A warning when it is close: choose 1 to 5 km in ⚙ Settings.
- **Change of plan:** *Not riding the bus*, *I'll pick up from school* or *Absent*, for today, tomorrow or a date. Cancel it with ✕.
- 🔔 **Messages:** boarding, arrivals, drop-offs, delays and school announcements.
- **Trip history** for each child.
- ⚙ **Settings:** phone notifications on/off, which alerts you want, light/dark mode, sign out.

The messages you will receive

🚌 Bus 1 has started the morning pickup

🚏 Bus 1 is at Kimironko stop

✅ Amina boarded Bus 1 at Kimironko · 06:58

🏫 Amina arrived at school · 07:45

🏠 Amina got off at Kimironko · 16:12

⚠️ Bus 1: heavy traffic, about 15 min late

Tell the bus before it comes. A "not riding" notice saves the bus from waiting at your stop and stops a no-show alert.

HELP

Questions and quick fixes

The answers to what people ask most in the first weeks.

I can't sign in

Check the phone number and that you are on the right page: parents at `/parent`, staff at `/auth`. Still stuck: ask the school for a new code.

I get no notifications

Open ⚙ Settings and turn notifications on, and allow them in the phone settings. On iPhone, the app must be added to the Home Screen first.

The bus shows "Connection lost"

The tracker has no mobile data for a while (tunnel, weak signal, SIM credit). It reconnects by itself; the last known position is shown meanwhile.

My child is not on the list

The attendant can search and add any child of the school; the school is told so the records can be fixed.

The minutes to my stop jump

They are worked out from the live position and road speed. Traffic changes them; they settle as the bus gets close.

The trip won't close

A child is still marked on board. Mark them off (or check the bus!), then confirm "the bus is empty".

A parent changed phone number

Students & parents → Parents: edit the number, then **Reset password** to send a new code.

Fingerprint check-in?

Under construction. Consent is already recorded at registration; when the readers are installed they replace the attendant's tap, everything else stays the same.

Privacy. Each parent sees only their own children and their bus. Photos are stored only with the parent's consent. The school can see and correct every record.

APPENDIX · DEMO VERSION

Try it: the demo accounts

The demo version is a separate copy of Live Track filled with a fictional school, **Sunrise Academy (Demo)**. Its 3 buses drive their routes by themselves, so the map, stop messages and arrival times work like the real thing. It rebuilds itself every night at 01:00, so nothing you do there can break it.

ROLE	SIGN IN AT	LOGIN	NOTES
School admin	`/auth`	school@demo.livetrack.app	Sunrise Academy (Demo)
Platform admin	`/auth`	admin@demo.livetrack.app	Sees every school
Attendant · Bus 1	`/auth`	0788 100 001	Kimironko line
Attendant · Bus 2	`/auth`	0788 100 002	Kicukiro line
Attendant · Bus 3	`/auth`	0788 100 003	Nyamirambo line
Parent · Grace Uwase	`/parent`	0788 200 001	2 children on Bus 1
Parent · Eric Mugisha	`/parent`	0788 200 002	1 child on Bus 1
Parent · Aline Ishimwe	`/parent`	0788 200 003	2 children on Bus 2

Password for every demo account: `demo1234`. The sign-in pages also show one-tap buttons for these accounts.

A 5-minute demo

1. **School admin** → Overview → Live map (fold the menu for a big map) → Students → open a child.
2. In a second browser: **Attendant Bus 1** → *Afternoon* → **Start afternoon trip** → tick children **On**.
3. On a phone: **Parent Grace** → see "boarded" arrive live, the bus on the map and the minutes to the stop.
4. Attendant → **Announce** → **Heavy traffic +15** → the parent receives it at once.
5. Attendant → **All off** → **End trip**. School admin → Attendance reports → **PDF**.